

SUBJECTIVE:

- * Patient reports a sore throat that started today.
- * She rates the severity of her throat pain as 5 out of 10.
- * The pain is localized to her throat and she denies any radiation.
- * She denies specific relieving factors.
- * She notes that swallowing and talking tend to aggravate her discomfort.
- * She denies associated symptoms such as fever, cough, runny nose, body aches, or difficulty breathing at this time.

OBJECTIVE:

* Expected Physical Exam Findings:

- * General: Patient would typically appear well and in no acute distress.
- * Vital Signs: Vital signs are not available from this interview, but would include temperature, heart rate, respiratory rate, and blood pressure.
- * Oropharynx: Examination would likely reveal erythema of the posterior pharynx. Tonsils may or may not show exudates or significant hypertrophy.
- * Neck: Palpation for tender anterior cervical lymphadenopathy would be performed.
- * Lungs: Clear to auscultation bilaterally.

ASSESSMENT:

- * Primary Diagnosis: Acute Pharyngitis
- * Differential Diagnoses:
 - * Viral pharyngitis (most common etiology)
 - * Group A Streptococcus (GAS) pharyngitis (strep throat)
 - * Irritant pharyngitis (e.g., environmental exposure)
 - * Allergic pharyngitis with post-nasal drip

PLAN:

* Tests:

- * Rapid Strep Antigen Detection Test (RADT) and/or throat culture to rule out bacterial pharyngitis, especially if clinical suspicion is high (e.g., fever, exudates).

* Medications:

- * Over-the-counter analgesics such as acetaminophen or ibuprofen for pain relief.
- * Throat lozenges or sprays for local symptom relief.
- * Warm saline gargles.
- * Antibiotics (e.g., penicillin or amoxicillin) would be prescribed only if Strep test is positive.

* Patient Advice:

- * Ensure adequate hydration with warm or cool liquids.
- * Get sufficient rest.
- * Avoid irritants such as smoke.
- * Practice good hand hygiene.
- * Follow-up Instructions:
 - * Return to clinic if symptoms worsen, develop a high fever, difficulty breathing or swallowing, or if there is no improvement within 48-72 hours.
 - * Follow up for Strep test results if performed.